AA-H-001198(GSA-FSS)
November 28, 1966

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HOUSEHOLD FURNITURE, WITH ARMS, WOOD & METAL PERIMETER BASE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information.. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers upholstered furniture units, consisting of chairs, davenports and davenport section on a wood or metal perimeter frame.

1.2 Classification. The seating units shall be of the following types, classes and styles as specified (see 6.2).

Type I. Wood frame
Type II. Metal frame

Class 1 - Chair, upholstered, with arms
Class 2 - Davenport

Style A. Double width
Style B. Triple width
Style C. Quadruple width

Class 3 - Davenport section

Style A. Single width, right arm
Style B. Single width, left arm

Class 4 - Bench, upholstered

Style A. Double width
Style B. Triple width

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

AA-H-570 - Household Furniture; Living Room Wood, Upholstered
QQ-N-290 - Nickel Plating (electrodeposited)
QQ-C-320 - Chromium Plating (electrodeposited)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 7105

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-20 - Welding Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables For Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-171 - Finishing of Metal and Wood surfaces

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Steel Products Manual, Carbon steel sheets

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Iron and Steel Institute, 150 East Forty-Second St., New York, New York 10017.

3. REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 Preproduction sample. Unless otherwise specified the preproduction sample requirements of paragraph 3.1 of specification AA-H-570 shall apply to items covered herein.

3.2 Materials. The materials used shall conform to the applicable requirements of paragraph 3.3 and sub paragraphs thereof of specification AA-H-570, and additionally to the materials requirements herein stated.

3.2.1 Steel. The tubular steel used in fabrication of the metal base shall be SAE 1010-1020 commercial quality cold rolled strip steel. It shall be bright, smooth, free from rust, scale, pits scratches, laps and buckles affecting strength or appearance. The gage numbers specified are the manufacturers standard gage for steel.

3.2.2 Plating.

3.2.2.1 Zinc plating. Zinc plating shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-171(ord), paragraph 5.1.1 (organic finishes) and of the kind shown in Table I, Finish 1.9 (zinc plating). The Type and class shall be 1.9.2 and 1.9.2.1. The final finish shall be bright.

3.2.2.2 Chromium plating. (Satin). Chromium plating shall be in accordance with QQ-C-320 class 1, Type II. The copper plus nickel undercoat on the steel base metal shall conform to class 1, Type III of QQ-N-290 on steel base metal.

3.2.3 Glides for metal bases. Glides shall be of the rubber or metal expanding adapter type with a rubber cushion on the upper surface between the glide and the furniture leg. The lower face (in contact with the floor) of the glide as well as all the exposed surface below the rubber cushion shall be highly polished stainless steel and shall be not less than 7/8 inch in diameter. The rubber cushion shall be not less than 1/8 inch thick.

3.3 Construction. The upholstered seating units covered by this specification shall consist of the following components: base frame, seat and back frames and upholstered cushions. The methods of construction specified in 3.4 of specification AA-H-570 for Class 2 furniture shall be followed except as otherwise specified herein:

3.3.1 Design. The design and style of the seating units shall approximate closely that illustrated in the attached photographs.

3.3.1.1 Dimensions. The dimensions of the units shall be as follows:

Size	Width of Seat	Depth of Unit	Height of Unit
Single width	24 inches	29 inches	31 inches
Double width	48 inches	29 inches	31 inches
Triple width	72 inches	29 inches	31 inches
Quadruple width	80 inches (each seat seating shall be 20 inches)	29 inches	31 inches

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Tolerances in dimensions shall be as follows:

Width of seat and base (-1/4 inch)
Depth of Unit ± 1/4 inch
Height of Unit ± 1 inch

3.3.2 Welding. All brazing and welding shall be as specified in MIL-STD-20 and shall be thoroughly cleaned of flash and spotter. All exposed brazing and welding shall also be ground smooth.

3.3.2.1 Definition of welding terms. Welding terms used herein shall be as defined in MIL-STD-20 and are as follows:

Fusion welding. Fusion welding consists of any welding process in which the weld is carried out solely by the melting of the metals to be joined, without any mechanical pressure. The joining is usually accomplished through the fusing of metal deposits from an external source.

Brazing. Brazing is the joining of metals with the aid of a filler metal of a different composition having a melting point above 800 degrees Fahrenheit. Brazing method shall be gasflux, using nickel bronze rod (nickel content 9.5%, Tensile strength 70,000 - 75,000 (p.s.i.) acetylene, and oxygen (or propane) gases.

3.3.3 Base frames shall be constructed as follows:

3.3.3.1 Type I Class 1, Class 2 and Class 3 (Wood). The base frame for Type I Units shall be made of any of the solid hardwoods listed in paragraph 3.3.4.1.1 of specification AA-H-570. The front, side and back rails shall be 1-13/16 inches wide by 1-1/16 inches thick. The legs shall be square in cross-section, 1-5/8 inches at top tapered to 1-1/8 inches at bottom. Frame rails shall be double-doweled or mortised and tenoned into the corner leg posts. The base frame shall be 25 inches deep measured at its top and shall be 10-3/8 inches high in front and 9-3/8 inches high at the back. The widths shall be as shown in Table I when measured at the top. These measurements do not include glides. Corner blocks shall be 1-1/4 x 1-1/4 inches accurately fitted and secured to frame with glue and at least one No.9 screw at each corner. Base frames over 50 inches wide shall have six legs. The base frame shall be secured to seating unit with No. 10 screws and there shall be not more than 7 inches between screws.

Table I. - Width of Frames

Capacity	Width (inches) minimum
Single	23
Double	47
Triple	71
Quadruple	71

3.3.3.2 Base frames for benches. Type I Class 4 (Wood). Shall be constructed as in 3.3.3.1 except, the legs shall be not less than 1-3/4 square, no taper (as shown in figure II), depth shall be 16 inches and shall be 13-1/4 inches high. The width shall be 36 inches for Style A an and 48 inches for Style B.

3.3.3.3 Type II Class 1, 2 and 3. (Metal). The metal base frame shall be fabricated of the tubular steel specified in 3.2.1. Legs, rails and stretchers shall be 1 inch square, 16 gauge tubing. All members shall be joined by continuous fusion welding or brazing specified in 3.3.2. The base frame at the front shall be 10-3/8 inches high and at the back shall be 9-3/8 inches high. The depth of the metal frame shall be 25 inches deep measured at the top of frame. Measurements are without glides. The base frame shall be secured to the seating unit with No. 10 screws spaced not more than 7 inches apart. Frames over 50 inches wide shall have six legs.

3.3.3.4 Type II Class 4. (Metal). Shall be of the construction specified in 3.3.3.3 except the end side rails shall be not less than 1-1/2 inch by 7/8 inch, depth shall be 16 inches and shall be 13-1/4 inches high. The width shall be 36 inches for Style A and 48 inches for Style B.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.4 Seat and Back Frame Construction. (except benches). Seat and back frame construction shall be in accordance with 3.4.2.2.1 of Specification AA-H-570. The front rail shall be 2-1/2 inches wide and the front and back spring rail shall be 3-1/2 inches doweled and glued with two 7/16 inch dowels; The front spring rail shall have a burlap tacking strip 1-1/16 inches square, glued and secured with No. 9 screws not more than 12 inches apart. At each end joint of the front spring rail there shall be two corner blocks 1-1/16 inch square in cross section by 3 inches long, glued and screwed with one No. 9 screw into each of the side rails. The back bottom base rail shall be 3-1/2 inches wide doweled and glued with two 7/16 inch dowels. The back spring rails shall be glued and screwed with No. 9 screws not more than 12 inches apart. There shall be two reinforcing blocks 1-1/16 inch square cross section by 3 inches long, glued and screwed to the side rails over the back base rail. The bottom outside back rail shall be 2-1/2 inches wide, and the top rail shall be 2-1/2 inches wide with a filler rail not less than 1-1/16 inches wide by 1/4 inch thick. The back center spring rail shall be 2-1/2 inches wide. Side rails shall be 2-1/2 inches wide and back posts 3 inches wide. Seats more than 36 inches long shall have stretchers as specified in 3.4.2.2.1 of AA-H-570. Springs shall be in accordance with 3.4.2.3.2.1 of AA-H-570 except V-shaped ends are not required. There shall be four springs 9 gage wire for each seat portion, and four springs of 12 gage wire for each back section. Installation of the springs to the seat and back shall be by means of brass clips with not less than three 7/8 inch No. 14 blued nails in each clip. Tops of all springs shall be joined together from side to side with steel reinforced tie-wire, covered with Kraft paper, clipped to each spring with one clip not less than 3/8 inch wide. Burlap as specified in 3.3.1.1 of AA-H-570 shall be applied over the springs and securely stapled to the frame at not less than two inch intervals. A flex-O-later pad shall be applied over the springs of the seat and back and hog ringed into place.

3.3.4.1 Upholstered frame (for benches). Seat shall be in accordance with 3.3.4 except side and end rails shall be 2-1/2 inches wide, double doweled. Springs shall be the same as in seat construction of 3.3.4. The bottom filler rails shall be not less than 2-1/2 inches wide.

3.3.4.2 Bench upholstered cushion. Bench cushion shall be fabricated with medium density flat pin core foam rubber specified in 3.3.1.8.3 of specification AA-H-570 in two inch thickness applied with adhesive over a three-ply plywood frame. The frame shall be two inches wide, 1/4 inch thick and of such width and length required to fit the bench frame. A layer of the cotton felt specified in 3.3.1.4 of AA-H-570 shall be applied over the pin core foam rubber. The upholstered material cover shall have a two inch boxing on four sides, with borders sewed at the welt lines. It shall then be pulled over and stapled on all four edges of the plywood frame. Slab stock rubber 3/16 inch thick and 2-1/4 inches wide shall be applied over end and side rails. The upholstered plywood frame with border flaps shall be pulled over the end and side rails and stapled to the bottom edge. Top shall be tufted with nylon tufting twine.

3.3.4.3 Seat Deck. Following application of the flex-O-later pad, a layer of cotton as specified in 3.3.1.4 of AA-H-570 shall be covered with denim specified in 3.3.1.1.3.1 of AA-H-570, color approximately that of the finished upholstery material, shall be stapled on all four edges to the top rails. The top cover of upholstery material specified in 3.3.1.14. shall be stapled to the top of the front rail and to the arm side rails. A 2 inch by 1/4 inch strip, 3-ply plywood shall be applied flush with the outside of the front rail extending the full width of the frame.

The edge roll conforming to 3.4.1.4.1 of AA-H-570, except size, shall be 1/2 inch and shall be securely stapled along the front edge of frame, cotton padding as specified in 3.3.1.4 shall be applied, and the upholstery cover material pulled over and stapled to bottom side of frame.

3.3.4.4 Upholstered Backs. Back cushion shall be fabricated with medium density flat pin core foam rubber specified in 3.3.1.8.3 of specification AA-H-570 in 2 inch thickness applied with adhesive over a 3-ply plywood frame. The frame shall be 2 inches wide, 1/4 inch thick and of such width as to fit the back. It shall be 15 inches high to allow the seat cushion to fit under it. A layer of the cotton felt specified in 3.3.1.4 of AA-H-570 shall be applied over the pin-core foam rubber. The upholstery material cover shall have a 2-1/4 inch boxing on 4 sides and shall be separated for each section, with borders sewed at the welt lines. It shall then be pulled over and stapled on all four edges of plywood frame. Slab stock rubber 3/16 inch thick and 4 inches wide shall be applied for a border to the top and side rails. The upholstered plywood frame with border flaps shall be pulled over the top and side rails and stapled to the back edges.

3.3.4.5 Seat cushions and covers. Seat cushions shall be reversible type made of 3-inch thick medium density flat pin-core foam rubber specified in 3.3.1.8.3 and shall be banded with 1/2 inch slab stock foam rubber on all four sides. Cover casings shall be as specified in 3.4.2.2.7.3 of AA-H-570. Cushion shall be full depth of frame and be under the attached back cushion.

The cushion boxing shall be 2-1/4 inch. Welt lines and appearance shall be required as illustrated in the photographs.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.4.6 Upholstered arms. Upholstered arms shall be 1-1/2 inches thick and conform to the design and dimensions of figure 1. A 1/2 inch thick by 1-1/2 inch wide solid stock foam rubber shall be applied on top and front of the arm. Hard board, 0.054 thick, shall be stapled to each side of the arm frame and a layer of cotton felt as specified in 3.3.1.4 shall be applied to both sides, front and top of the arm upholstery material, as specified in 3.4.2, with 1-1/2 inch boxing and welts as shown in attached photographs shall cover the arm. The upholstered arm shall be secured to the seat and back main frame with not les than four, 1/4 inch bolts, keeping it flush with the bottom and back of frame.

3.3.4.7 Outside Backs. The outside back shall be applied as specified in 3.4.1.7 of AA-H-570.

3.3.4.8 Upholstery completion. The entire bottom shall be covered with cambric specified in 3.3.1.3 of AA-H-570, which shall be attached, glazed side down, by stapling to all four rails.

3.3.5 Finish.

3.3.5.1 Type I, (Wood). The requirements for finish spacified in 3.5.1.1.2 of specification AA-H-570 shall apply. Unless otherwise specified the color of finish shall be walnut.

3.3.5.2 Type II (Metal). Metal frame components including legs shall be chromium plated in accordance with 3.2.2.2 herein and shall be given a satin finish.

3.3.6 Labels. Each item of furniture shall have a label attached to conform to the legal requirement of the state in which the item is manufactured.

3.3.7 Identification marking. Each piece shall be marked on the underside using marking ink with the stock number, contractor's name or trademark, the contract number and the year of manufacture.

3.3.8 Workmanship. The finished unit pieces shall be clean and well made. Upholstered cover shall be carefully tailored and applied smoothly and evenly. Seams shall be properly aligned and firmly stitched. Covers shall be matched in pattern and weave. Wood joints shall be accurate and firm. Metal joints shall be clean and accurate. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the acceptable quality level specified herein.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Inspection responsibility. The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in Standard MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.2 End item inspection.

4.2.2.1 Visual examination. Examination of the furniture units shall be in accordance with the Classification of Defects in 4.3.2.1 and 4.3.3.1.1 of specification AA-H-570 and Table I herein. The lot size shall be expressed in units of any one type and class of upholstered furniture units for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with standard MIL-STD-105. The inspection level and acceptable quality level for this examination shall be as specified in Table III.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table I - Classification of defects for Type II item

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Material	Steel components not of the material or gage specified.	X	
Workmanship	Any component missing malformed or fractured.	X	
	Welds not ground smooth or free of pits and splatter.		X
	Welds cracked, fractured, burned through or not fused.	X	
	Burns or sharpness on any component.		X
Finish	Not as specified.	X	
	Not uniform		X

4.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. Examination shall be made for conformance with overall dimensions specified. Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

4.2.2.3 Examination for the preparation for delivery requirements. An examination will be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects will be scored in accordance with table II. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected just prior to closure operations. Defects of closure shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table II. Classification of Preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Marking	Incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Material	Any nonconforming components, component missing, damaged or otherwise defective affecting serviciability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of Components such as incomplete closure of shroud.
Contents	Not as specified

4.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's). Inspection and acceptable quality levels expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as shown in Table III.

TABLE III. Acceptable quality levels in accordance with MIL-STD-105

+	Inspection levels	Major	Total
For defects listed in 4.2.2.1	II	2.5	10.0
For defects listed in 4.2.2.2	S3		4.0
For defects listed in 4.2.2.3	S2		4.0

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4 Tests. In addition to the tests specified in 4.4 of AA-H-570, the following tests shall be performed.

4.4.1 Bend test for steel sheets. The steel sheets used for parts to be formed shall withstand a 180 degree bend at room temperature with and across the grain without showing any crystallization, cracks or fractures on the outside of the bend.

5. Preparation for Delivery. Packaging, Packing and Marking shall be as specified in the invitation for bid.

6. Notes.

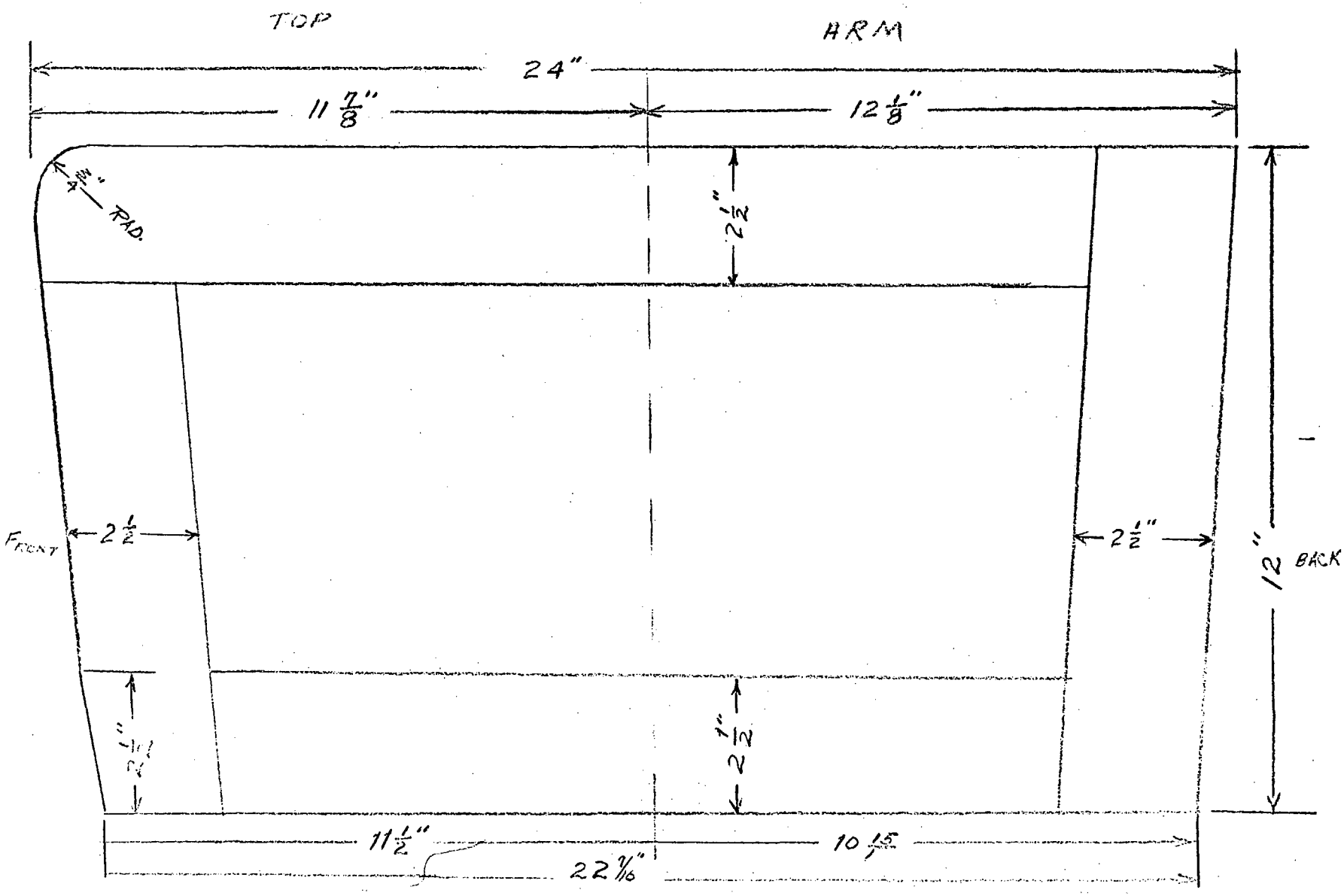
6.1 Intended use. The seating units covered by this specification are intended for use in living quarters.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number, title and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class and style required.
(c) Upholstery cover required.
(d) When preproduction sample requirement is waived.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FIGURE 1 . Arm frame assembly.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

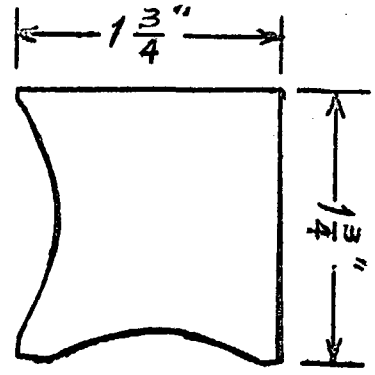
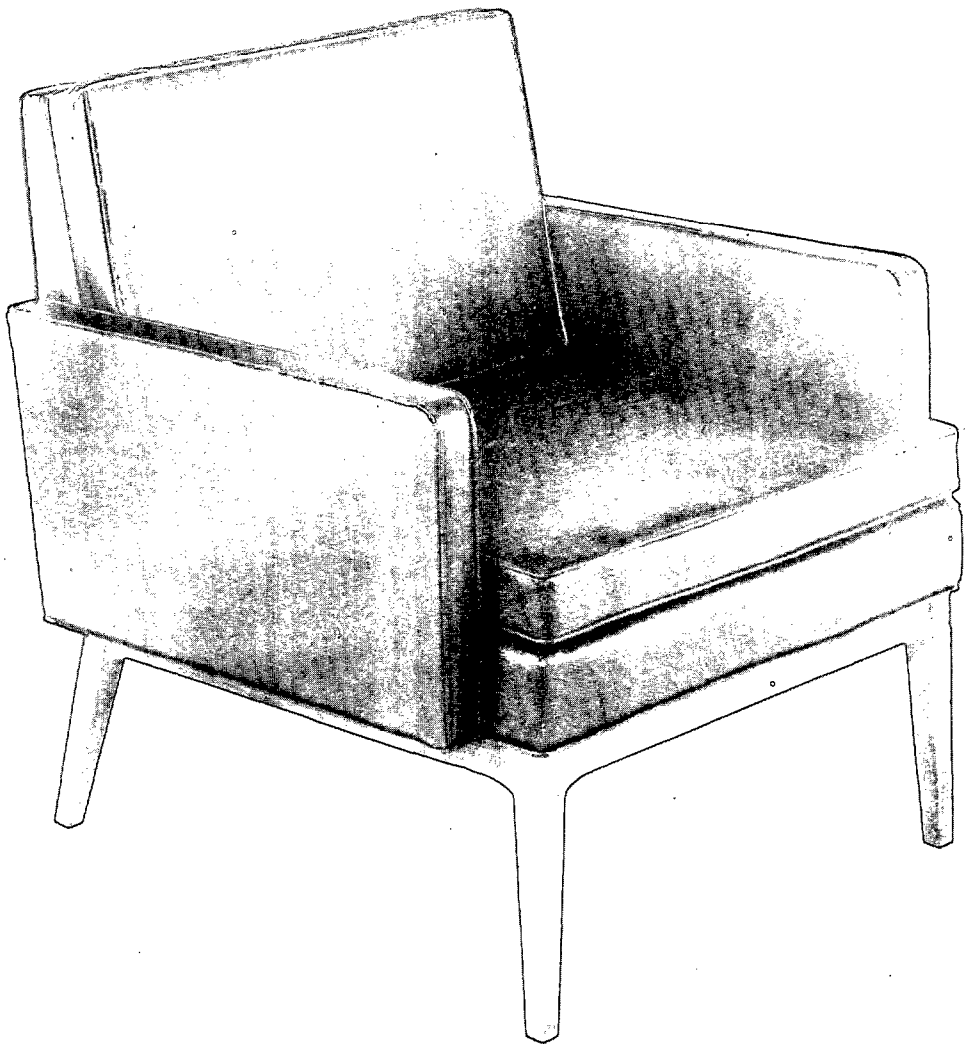


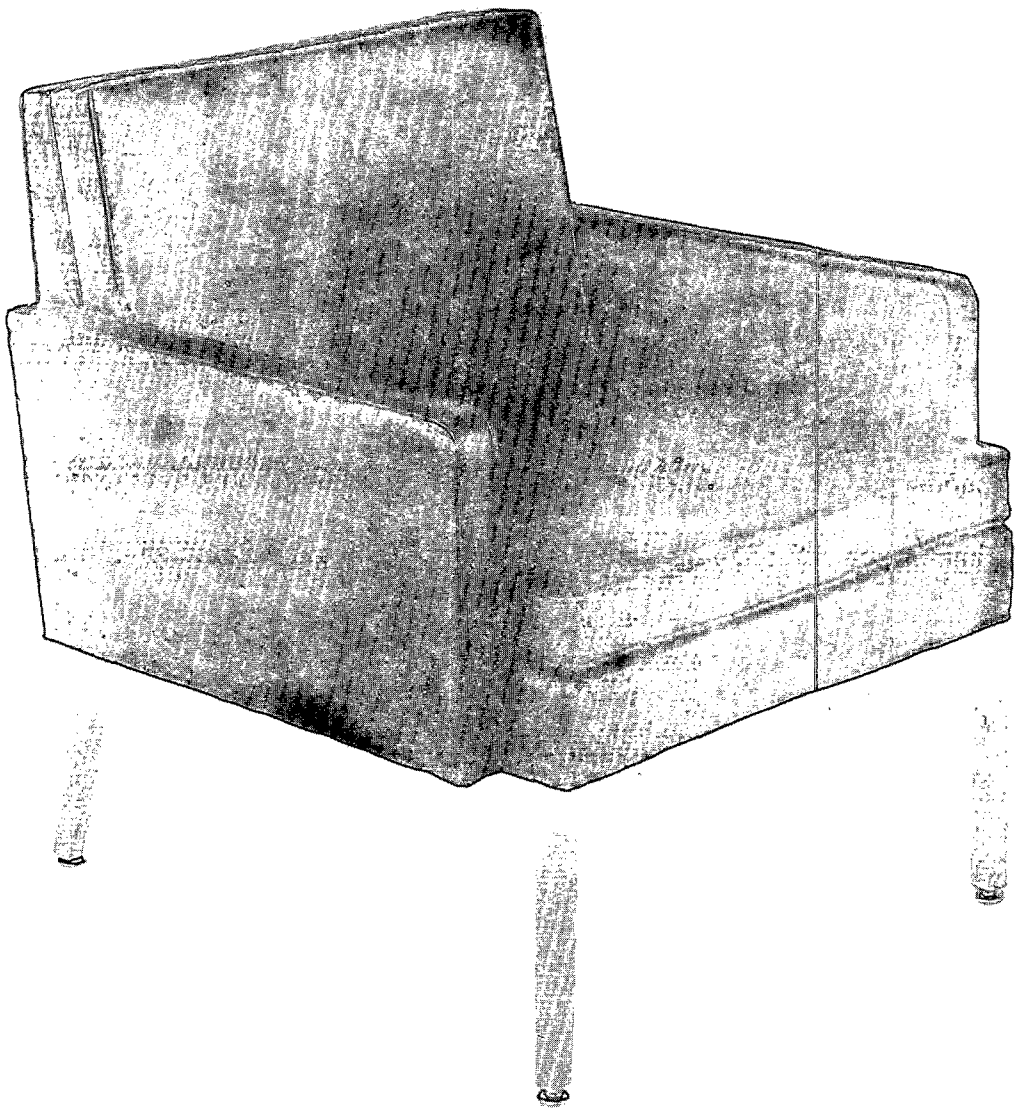
FIGURE 2. Bench leg cross-section

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



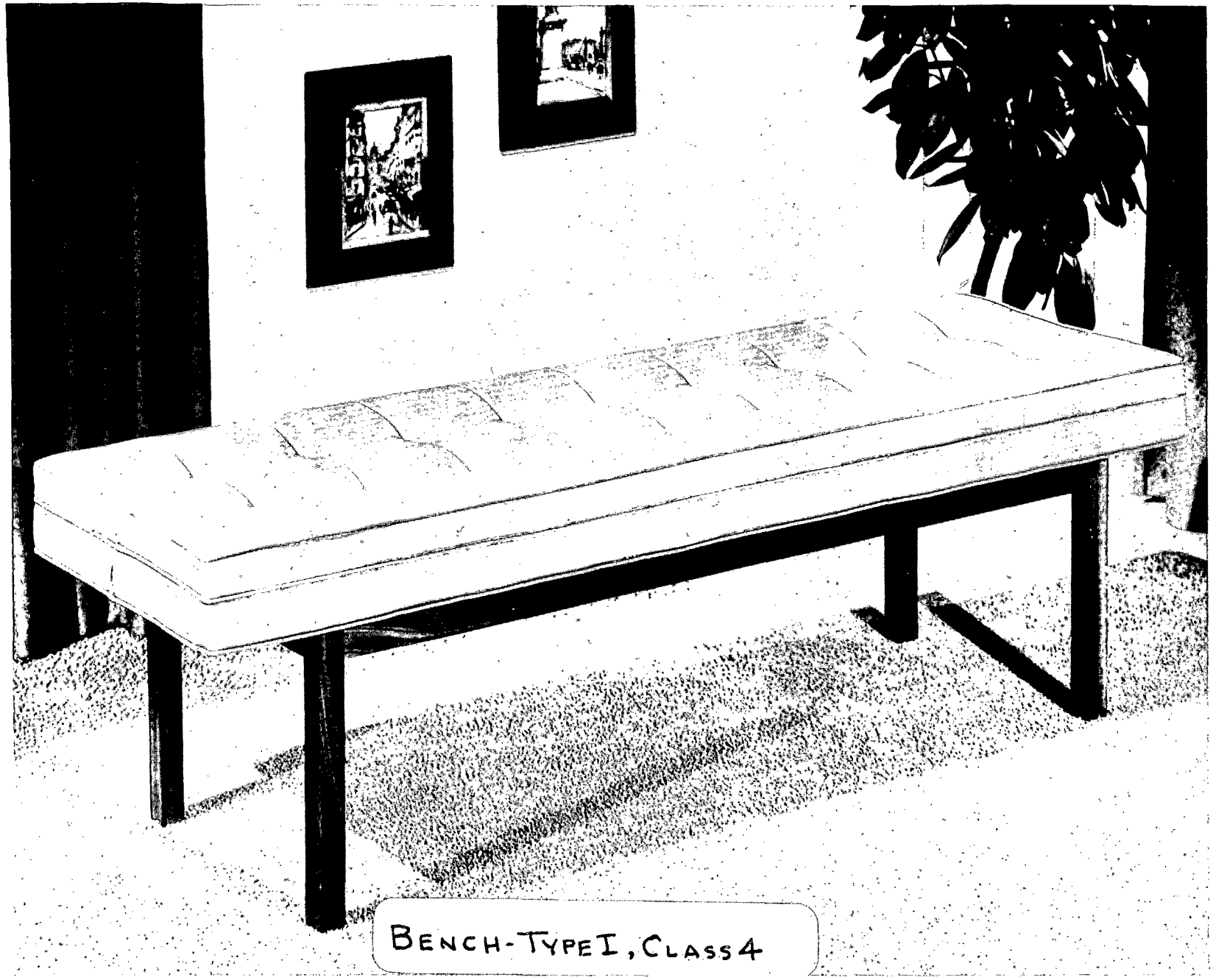
CHAIR - TYPE I, CLASS 1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

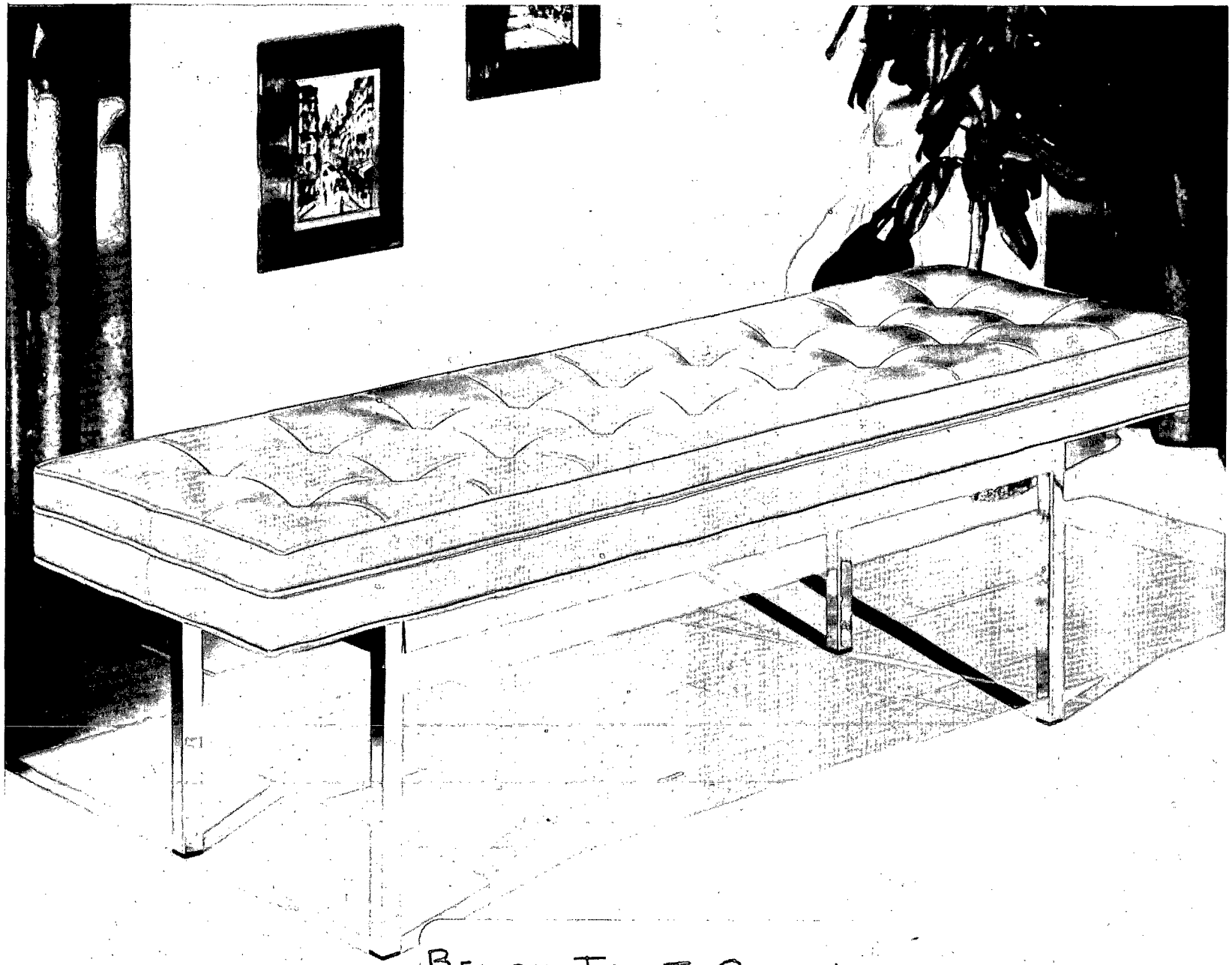


CHAIR - TYPE II, CLASS 1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

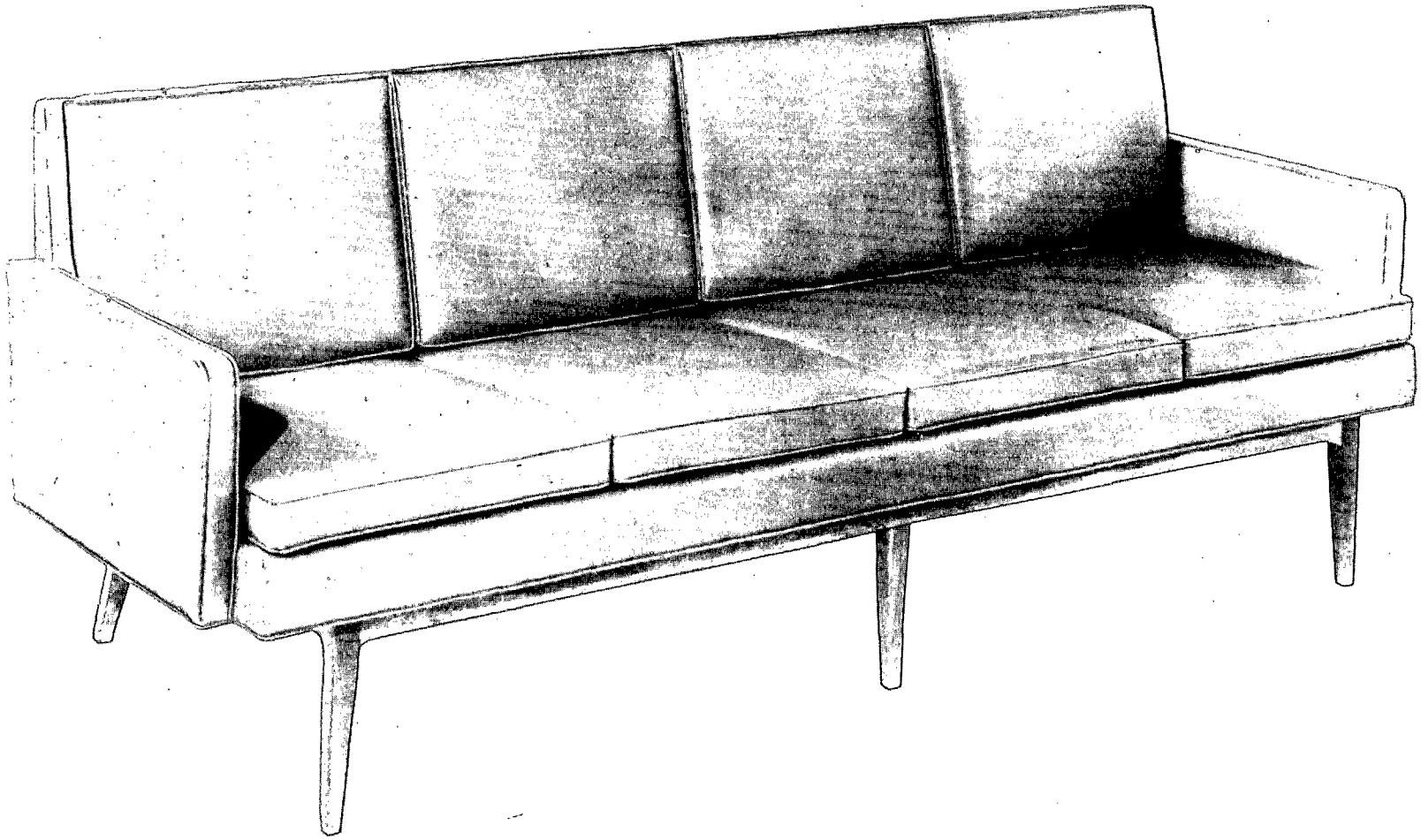


Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



BENCH - TYPE II, CLASS 4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



DAVENPORT- TYPE I, STYLE C

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.